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identify key facts, extract usable quotes, flag contradictions and suggest chapter or article structure.

- **Approval rule:** do not invent citations. Mark missing information clearly.
- **Output:** research brief, fact table, quote bank and unanswered questions.

The agent becomes a librarian, not a ghostwriter.

About consent

Before connecting data, ask who owns it and who is affected by it. Your own notes are one thing. Customer complaints, student records, employee messages, patient information and client contracts are different. Even if a tool technically allows upload or connection, that does not mean you have ethical or organisational permission to use it.

For businesses and institutions, create a simple consent rule: customer, student, employee and client data should only be used with approved tools, approved purposes and minimum required access. When in doubt, anonymise.

Multiple versions of truth problem

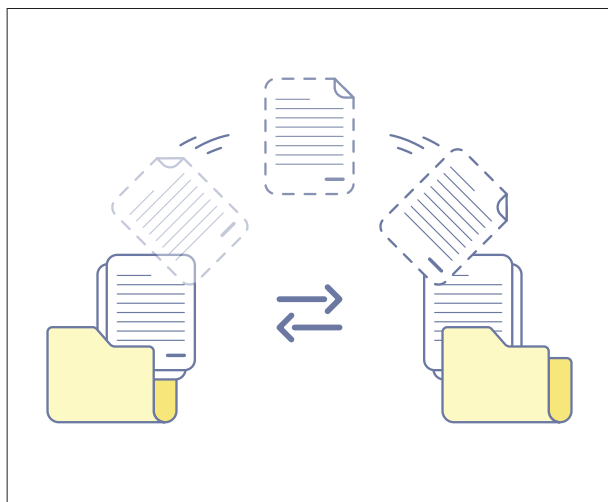
Connected agents may see multiple versions of the same information. One spreadsheet says the deadline is June 10. An email says June 12. A calendar invite says June 14. Which one is correct? Unless you tell the agent, it may choose badly.

Maintain a source-of-truth hierarchy. For example: signed contract beats email; project tracker beats chat message; official timetable beats forwarded screenshot; finance sheet beats memory. Include this hierarchy in your agent instructions.

A useful prompt line is: “If sources conflict, do not guess. Show the conflict and ask me to decide.”

Logs, versioning and rollback

Every serious connected workflow needs traceability. You should know what the agent accessed, what it changed, when



AGENT CONNECTION CHECKLIST

Before connecting an agent, run this checklist.

- What task will this connection solve?
- Which exact files, folders or apps are needed?
- Is the data public, private or sensitive?
- Can the task work with read-only access?
- What actions are prohibited?
- Where must the agent ask for approval?
- Can I see logs or version history?
- Can I revoke access easily?
- Have I tested with old or copied data?
- What is the recovery plan if something goes wrong?

If you cannot answer these questions, do not connect yet.

it changed it and why. For personal use, this may be as simple as saving dated outputs. For business use, logs and version history are essential.

Use version names such as “Lead-Sheet-Agent-Test-2026-07-04.” Ask the agent to produce a change summary. Use tools with file history or undo options. Avoid workflows where one click can overwrite critical data with no recovery path.

Disconnecting is also a skill

Power users do not just connect tools. They also disconnect them. Remove access after a project ends. Delete test automations. Revoke permissions for tools you no longer trust. Clean up shared folders. Remove old API keys. Check app permissions every month.

An agent workflow you forgot about may still have access to files you now consider sensitive.

Useful, limited access is the key

Connected agents are most powerful when they are focused. Give them enough information to do the job and enough restriction to prevent damage. The goal is not to build an all-seeing assistant that knows everything about your life. The goal is to build small, useful workflows that make repeated tasks easier.

Start with one folder, one workflow, one output and one approval point. Make it reliable. Then expand slowly.

The future of AI agents will be deeply connected. They will read documents, understand calendars, work across apps, query databases and trigger workflows. But the best users will not be the people who connect everything. They will be the people who connect wisely.

Useful access is not maximum access. Useful access is the minimum access required to get the job done well. 